one of the reasons I think we do really well here is that I've yeah lived in various states looked after clients in
3:44
uh yeah various jurisdictions all the way from yeah retail you know just you know people buying their first home to
3:50
obviously big private banking clients. So yeah it's been it's been a journey but um yeah I always say everything that
3:56
everything I've gone through so far has really set me up well for for where the business is right now. Um,
4:02
so yeah, I background I grew up in Brisbane. So, uh, out in Cleveland for any other Brisbaneites that are there

My dad and my brother's still there. Um so my yeah I started um very very unorthodox
4:47
background. So at school I studied music. So I actually um yeah studied to be an orchestral musician. I went to the
4:53
conservatorium in in Brisbane. Um but dropped out cuz I uh kind of just burnt
4:59
myself out. Uh I think anyone that especially if you got any kids that are doing this um or anyone that's done
5:04
anything that's very it's about high performance, you can um you know I spent the last 2 three years of my high school
5:10
like literally just doing music every day and you work so hard for that one a day. So that one day to get the audition
5:17
to because to get in you have to audition. Um and you know it's very competitive. Um,
5:22
you know, I think my year that I went in, they took six of us, but there was like 80 100 people that auditioned to
5:28
get in trying out for. So, you got to you got to really push yourself and then once you get there, you you know, think you're the best in a
5:34
in a smaller pond and then you get there, everyone's at the same or as even way better than you. And I think I was
5:40
just young. I kind of really burnt myself out and yeah, wanted to take a little break and just do something completely different

5:45
because it had kind of consumed my whole life. So I got a job doing a trainee
5:50
ship as a bank teller at NAB. Um Carell shopping center was my first my first
5:56
gig. Yeah. Fantastic. Yeah. Is it still open today? Banks are shutting down a lot. It's still around. It's still around.
6:02
It's a big shopping center in in Brisbane. So can you still, you know, get get money out from a person there?
6:08
You can, but probably limited to $3,000. These days I don't carry a lot. No. Yeah. But that was it was a I mean to be
6:14
honest it was a brilliant it was a brilliant training ground because um yeah it was this was the middle mid 2000s. Um

yeah handling a lot of cash dealing with a lot of a lot of customers. Um was really like I cut my teeth very quickly.
6:26
Can you imagine like I went from pure academics, pure music to suddenly sitting at a bank branch and dealing
6:33
with all this. I'd never I had boyfriend hospitality before similar to you. So I my very first job ever was washing
6:39
dishes at a restaurant in Cleveland. a chef at the back of KFC restaurant.
6:44
Yes. Lemon herbs and spices. I'll never tell the recipe.
6:50
A few a few drinks will get it out of your I'm sure. I'm sure. Um so yeah, and then I worked in in restaurants up until I um up until I got
the gig at NAB. So I mean that was that was good training because obviously anyone that's worked in hospitality knows you've got to deal with a lot of very difficult
7:03
people sometimes. Client services as well. You put there's a lot of empathy. you put yourself in their shoes and having that relationship
7:10
with a with a with a client. Um it's it it does I suppose bode very well in terms of that client relationship and being able
7:16
to um relate and help help service clients. Yeah, definitely. And I I think there's a lot to be said about people that also work

way from the ground up and go into some of these relationship jobs as well cuz yeah, I've seen all types of people, you know, especially when I especially those
7:30
first few years at NAB when I worked in branches. I was in yeah various parts of like Brisbane like West End and um
7:36
Stones Corner and and Cararendale and Winnham like some you know a couple of them that are a bit rough and you know
7:41
you'd see some very all types of people in there but it really does open your eyes to kind of um what's the word
7:48
looking after everyone no matter where they come from. Also don't judge a book by its cover right that's a big thing especially
7:56
definitely learned that up here actually yeah the some of my wealthiest clients you wouldn't know it I'll tell you that
8:01
but um see a Ferrari turn up at a hawker center and they go buy family food for like $10 and they get get back in their
8:07
Ferrari. Yeah. Um so yeah, I did my training ship with
8:12
the bank and by that time I just I wasn't ready to go back to to music. So I ended up um NAB wanted me on
8:19
full-time. I moved to Melbourne. So I worked down in South Melbourne branch and a couple of others but mainly South
8:24
Melbourne. Yeah. Where the where the famous Tim Sims come from. Yes. Yes. Yes. Yes. pop out for lunch, few dinners and back
8:31
to the off back to the bank. Yep. Um and look, I love Melbourne. Melbourne was great for me. I was there for about seven years. And my you know, my time in
8:37
NAB there was really great too. So I was working in branches. I was working as like a home home lending manager.
8:43
Uh then I worked in their credit team. So that was probably the best job I ever had cuz um this was like
8:48
apart from now. Apart from now. Yeah. I mean when just just at the bank, just at the bank. So
8:53

cuz you were just literally all day you just get an application, you decide am I going to approve this or not? So you were the one with with the power.
9:01
But I kind of Yeah, I loved it. Um and it was in 2000 it was like 2009 2010 so it was just after the GFC as well. So we
9:09
saw a lot of um yeah just crazy um yeah um crazy scenarios and especially if
9:16
anyone remembers back then the Gold Coast was like devastated economically then like we had a lot of
9:21
clients that have purchased offplan properties that were when you got the valuation done 40 50% less than what
9:26
they paid. Wow. for them. Um so it was yeah very a good play good time to cut your teeth. Um then from
9:32
there I worked in so my last kind of what 201 uh 2010 to 2015 I was in private
9:41
banking uh with NAB all the way I was working here but yeah 20 so about 5 years working in Melbourne. Uh my first
9:48
job was looking after Goldman Sachs partners and JB partners and that was when Goldman Sachs did their restructure
9:54
after the GFC as well. So that was a very interesting interesting time to be there. A lot of bloodletting. Uh again
10:01
gave me a lot of uh perspective on you on investment banking and just um yeah
10:07
very very interesting people to talk to and um then yeah I moved to Perth so back in 2013 to 2015. So I was there for
10:14
two years. Um and I was there the 2013 was right when the boom was happening but then it fell off very very quickly.
10:21
So again, it was very interesting to go at a time and it was like really on but then really off very quickly. I think um I remember our rent was this is some crazy price. I think like
10:32
and this is again 10 10 12 years ago. Um yeah it was like 1,200 a week when we
10:38
moved there but within the space of four uh within two years it had dropped to like 740 or something. So it did like
10:44

just went down. That's phenomenal. Yeah. Did you were you dealing with much distressed credit then as well? Uh I was
10:50
in uh I was in private banking then so we didn't have a lot of distressed clients fortunately. Um a lot of them
10:56
managed it really well. Um, again a very interesting place to be cuz you know Perth's a small town and I was kind of
11:02
working in their ultra high net worth team and yeah all the kind of big families that you can think of that are
11:08
there and uh we were dealing with them and dealing with their offices and yeah just um
11:14
all of it really really great experience and especially on the lending side you know we were just that those were the days in private banking where you know
11:21
we did everything. So I was doing, you know, commercial developments, big apartment towers, pubs, hotels, as well
11:28
as like big high-end properties as well. So yeah, I kind of, you know, I loved it. Um, I was definitely nab
11:35
indoctrinated by then as well. It was, they'd always looked out from the Kool-Aid.
11:41
But yeah, so yeah, 20 2015, uh, my ex at the time got a job up here, so we made
11:46
the move up to to Singapore. Um yeah, it was I think um you know I was
11:53
really really excited to be able to have the chance to live overseas because it's something I'd always wanted to do and
11:59
just you know life had not really gotten to that point yet. Um but obviously coming over here
12:05
very much the same realization that you guys have. Um I came at a time uh that
12:11
they were really there was all the banks were going into hiring freezes. So, I had um had a couple of job offers
rescended. A&Z offered me a job and then two weeks later said, "We're in a hiring freeze. We can't offer to you." I think it was HSBC was another one. Um I was
12:26
talking to Bank of Singapore. Then they like changed their strategy. So, it was a lot of like I would kind of get to a
12:31

certain point and then it just would not quite get there. Um so, it was a bit disheartening. I won't lie.
12:37
It was like I think for me especially, um you know, the best thing that came out of it was I told you I might have
12:42
mentioned this in the other episode. I used to just go on LinkedIn every day and I used to look for other Australians that worked in banking up here to to try
12:49
and find a job. Um, and the best thing ever is, you know, when I decided to start my business, all of those people are my clients now. So, at the time it
12:56
was a really disheartening thing and it was a struggle and but you know it's a again I talked about certain things with
13:02
fate. It was it really really turbocharged my my network when I first started my business. um
13:09
put yourself out there like and it's it's like we we've all come from that um kind of I think successful
13:16
career in Australia and then you come overseas like oh this is a much bigger bigger thing but like you kind of reset
13:21
press that reset button and it's quite it is hard I think I was 100 plus applications just send
13:27
oh I I stopped after a while I think the same thing I used to put in like 10 every morning and then I don't think a
13:33
single one ever called me maybe one and it's funny Because when you first
13:38
before you come over, you look on the job site, right? And you think, "Oh, there's all these amazing jobs here and I just have to apply for them and
13:44
they're going to definitely want to talk to me and absolutely no way. I can take my pick
13:50
and you know, life unless you have a very specialized skill set I've learned. It's it's very hard to get through um
13:56
through the HR uh portals here." So um but no, eventually NAB did find me a
14:01
job which I was again very very thankful for. They were great. Um but yeah, I just started work and I think 4 months,
14:07

5 months later, they decided they were pulling out of Asia. So I kind of started and just started to get my feed and then
14:13
yeah um but again it's you know I was very very lucky because um
14:19
they I was able to you know I took a package I took I took a retrenchment with them. Um but getting retrenched was
14:26
the greatest thing that ever happened to me. So cuz sometimes in life you can get very comfortable and think you want
14:33
to just be in a certain place but this was a big push for me to go what do I really want to do
14:39
next? And I had um by that time again it's you know I say this is well once you've got your first job here it
14:44
becomes a lot easier because you just build more of a network and people know how you work but um I had a couple of
14:50
other jobs lined up but they were at other international banks but I remember just being like I don't want to do this
14:56
anymore. Yeah. Yeah, that's a good point. It's just not like, you know, I've been doing this for 12 years now and
15:04
what else is it that I can do cuz I think anyone that's worked at a bank knows that you can get very burnt out and kind of a bit over it. Um,
15:11
so yeah, I was very very lucky. Um, so in mortgage broking, we have something called an aggregator, which is
15:16
a there are big companies in Australia that help us manage the relationships between all the banks. And so one of the
15:22
co-founders of the aggregator that I use, uh, Finchureaw, he reached out to me on LinkedIn very randomly cuz he just
15:29
moved here for other reasons and other businesses that he had and said he wanted to pick my brain on things. And it was right when I was leaving. He's
15:35
like, I've got this mortgage broking aggregator. Have you ever thought about it? You've like, you know, got all the
15:41
experience and all the all the all the news to to do it. And so, yeah, I took a moment, I don't

15:48
know. Do I want to do this? cuz it's funny when you work in the bank you they tell you mortgage brokers are absolutely evil and that they're just out to steal
15:54
your clients and we hated mortgage brokers like you know and this again this is 10 years ago the industry's come a long way
16:01
in that time um so I was like oh do I want to do I want to be one of those the dark side
16:06
yeah but then the thought of like you know there there's not an equivalent type of job up here there's international banks don't do Australian
16:13
property and even just other property lending in the same way that we do it back home so like I have all these skills, what am I
16:20
going to do with it? And so, fortunately, um, I just I took a punt. I'm like, "Okay, I'll start this. I'll
16:26
get it going. I'll see if it's got any legs or not." And yeah, seven and a half years later, still.
16:31
Well, I'm thankful you are, mate, cuz it's all my clients. So, it's good that that would have been,
16:38
I suppose, extremely difficult time for for you to go through that. Obviously,
16:43
taking that plunge. tell us a bit more about about that time in terms of obviously setting up a business
16:49
offshore. Maybe that's that's a that's a interesting interesting part of it, but then also um kind of growing that
16:55
business as well. Obviously you were a oneman band at the start and then you've got a successful team around you.
17:00
Maybe maybe go through a little bit more detail about setting up business offshore and then also how do you expand
17:06
that grow that business? I'd really love to know what was the very first thing you did day one team
17:11
woke up said I came up with the name that was my first thing. Yep. So, I came up like what am I going to call my business? And then I was like, I
want someone to be able to look at our brand and they know exactly what we do. Australian Homelands got no idea what
17:24
they do. That's true. Um, and I mean it served it served us well so far. And you know, um,

17:32
so yeah, that was number one. Um, and then I just, yeah, I guess um, I got good accountancy advice uh, to set all
17:38
the companies up and what do the structures need to look like and you know, they approved my visa and I'm still thankful to the Singapore
17:44
government for that. So um yeah cuz it's it's yeah like I said
17:49
it's it's um the opportunity that's given me here and you know it's it was the first couple of years it was
17:55
literally me in my room just doing everything myself from start to finish. So just
18:01
um yeah I think it's going to kind of talking about the business side of it. Um you know when you when you start any
18:08
business right you've got to think about how do I get people in the door? How do I get people want to work with me? So
18:13
the first year especially and any mortgage, you know, any mortgage broker will tell you the first year is the
18:19
hardest because in mortgage broking it takes a long time from the day you see someone sometimes to the day they actually buy or or settle on their loan.
18:26
So it was a lot of coffees. It was a lot of just me reaching out to all my old clients uh even just anyone that would
18:33
want to talk to me and um just really kind of slowly slowly built it organically from the ground up. But the
18:41
biggest thing that I love here is that, you know, everyone, and it's probably the same for you guys with your clients,
18:47
every client is so appreciative of service. Yeah. Yep. Here, and being able to see you, being
18:52
able to look you in the eye, being able to solve problems and just get things sorted together. Again, this was back in what, 2017, 2018. So,
18:59
everything was paper paper based. It would be um I'd be out signing and doing everything with them.
19:05

Um, so yeah, it was very very manual, but it's and it was the time of the Royal Commission, too. So, the lending landscape was very
19:12
very tough. It was probably the hardest time ever to start the business just from an options and a lending
19:18
perspective. But in a way, I'm really grateful for that because you get put into the fire and
19:23
you've like, you know, it's only up only up from there. Exactly. Exactly.
19:29
So, and it taught me a lot about getting things right, getting the systems together. Um yeah, I think in terms of
19:34
where it started really growing was during co that was um yeah very surreal
19:39
experience from a business perspective. It's um I started to put staff on at that point. So yeah, my first staff
19:46
member was middle of 2020 and then by the middle of 21 I think I had three. Um
19:52
but yeah, it was you know it went from me really having to grind and you know we we'd still done well for two years.
19:58
like I'd still um you know we um by all by all metrics we were still growing and
20:04
growing but it wasn't you know it was still just me it was almost like a sole consultancy right um
20:09
so co everyone being at home um I can't begin to tell you what it was like just
20:15
what happened with my phone with the internet inquiries like nothing had changed in terms of my advertising or
20:21
how I was marketing myself the just if you remember as well everyone thought the property market was going to fall
20:26
off an absolute cliff Yeah, one of kind of was was sideways down a little
20:31
bit at the start of 2020, but then at after there was a good there was there was
20:37
Yeah, there's a good two three months where I'll never forget and we'll probably get we'll probably get this client on hopefully. Uh he bought a place in
20:43
Freshwater for like I think it was four 4 million and the valuer valued it at like 10 or 20% less than what he paid

20:50
for and Freshwater Sydney is like you know prestige property and that place must be I don't
20:55
know it'll be worth a lot more. Yeah. Yeah. Now, and you know, at the time it was really stressful cuz we were just like,
21:01
what what are we going to do? But yeah, it just shows you how things can really like change so quickly, too. Um,
21:07
so yeah, by the second half of 2020, it just we grew exponentially. I had some really good lenders come in. So,
21:14
um, yeah, co for me was when I really got to actually build it into something that was, you know, wasn't just about me
necessarily. Now, you know, we had built a team around me. Um and then yeah, the last
21:27
kind of two years has been the next chapter after that. So um I've been very
21:32
lucky. Um like we've been able to expand um our offices. So I have another office up in Hong Kong now. So I've got a
21:39
broker working with me up there. His name's Sean. Um I'll get him on at some point, but he's been absolutely
21:44
brilliant. And um yeah, we've got a business down in Melbourne, too, which um different name, Urbane Finance. If
21:50
anyone that's my client, you probably see some marketing for it. But um I really wanted to create um a world or an
21:56
ecosystem where we can look after clients not just up here but also when they go back to Australia as well and kind of yeah do the do the
22:03
whole journey with them because the reality is yeah just the longer you're here the more and more people do go home. Yeah.
22:08
Every year and I want to still be able to bring the same level of service that we give up here to to our clients back home as well. So
22:14
yeah it's turned into a whole thing now. I think we'll have like 20 staff soon and multiple brokers and
22:20
it's been a journey that's for sure. It's journey but you put the hard yards in and um it's yeah very successful um

22:26
for you. Um and I'm sure there's still going to be ch some challenges ahead in the future as well. It's not like the challenges stop um at that point in time
22:34
your part of being in Singapore. What's your favorite thing about being up here or being offshore? Probably two three things for me that
22:40
are the most important. And the first one is yeah everyone everyone says that it's travel. Yeah. Yeah, exactly.
22:46
Especially now that I travel a lot for work, cuz I'm up in Hong Kong, I'm I'm back in Melbourne quite a lot. Um, so being in the center of everything, if I
22:53
want to go somewhere, that's yeah, the number one. And obviously it's the Singapore life. I love to get away when I can. So
22:59
back to Jamie's question, my podcast, what's your favorite destination? Uh, I mean, you know, I go to Thailand a
23:05
lot, so it's probably Yeah, Bangkok's one of my favorite places, I think. Um, yeah, I just I don't know. I love
23:10
getting away. I love Hong Kong as well. Um and then yeah, anytime I can get to Europe as well, it's probably my top.
23:16
But yeah, in Asia, Thailand for sure 100%. Um and then yeah, second would be
23:23
um I mean, yeah, the opportunity that Singapore has given to me to be able to
23:29
build a business here to be able to yeah, create something that I probably never would have been able to do back
23:35
home or build it in the same way. And you know, yes, like our our our loans
23:41
are a lot more difficult to write, but I'm the clients that I have here are just such appreciative people. And
23:48
yeah, I think it's, you know, we've most of my business was born out of word of mouth in the first kind of especially
23:54
the first three to four Yeah. years and being part of a community here, being part of some
23:59
something where all of us have a shared experience and a common experience and you can just literally we go to any event, any any new Australian that you

24:05
meet, you can instantly just be able to talk some uh talk about your your experience here and have something in
24:11
common. Well, someone says like um property is Australia's number one sport.
24:16
Yes. every everyone participates in it, everyone wants to be part of it and and it's true like bricks and mortar is a

massive and I think it's a generational thing, right? So, um like my parents, my
24:28
parents' parents, they've all enjoyed success through buying property. Um and
24:34
it's just one of those one of those things that I suppose comes from from generations ago that and again the the
24:40
Australian dream, maybe not the American dream, but is having that white picket fence in the house that you could you could you could live live in um for most
24:48
people. So um it's very easy to talk to to people about Yeah, 100%. And probably the last one um
24:55
so yeah, my obviously I talked about my my geeky hobby. So I still um the best
25:00
thing that ever happened to me is you know after I stopped going to music school, I kind of gave up playing for a
25:06
long time. I studied clarinet for I don't know if I mentioned that before. Um but you didn't I was waiting on a ask you
25:12
about it. So this is cuz I'm I'm I'm I'm going to go watch you this Sunday, Tim. You are. You're a big supporter of my
25:18
concerts. I appreciate it, Tristan. Um so yeah, before I moved to to Singapore, um I,
25:25
you know, I hadn't played for a long time, you know, 7 8 n years. So when I first moved here, obviously I had a lot
25:31
of time in my hands and I thought, what am I going to do with that time? Um so
25:37
yeah, I started getting lessons with one of the players from the SSO again. Um, I started auditioning for orchestras here.
25:42

And one of the great things in Singapore is actually there's a million different community groups. And even you could be
25:48
at like the most basic community group here. There's still 50 string players at the front giving it giving it their all
25:54
as well. You try and do the same thing in Australia. Maybe people don't keep it up in the same way that they do here. So, but I've had some really cool
26:00
experiences. My first my first year that I moved here, I got to do a music tour with um the Singapore Wind Symphony. We
26:05
went to Korea for two weeks. So, I'd never been to Korea before. I'd never been in a country where not everyone
26:11
speaks English. Um, so that was a and I'd never been on a bus with Singaporeans hearing very heavy English
26:17
accents for the whole time. So that was my baptism of fire just trying to understand understand the culture a bit more.
26:23
Yeah. No, that is good. But I I loved it. Um, you know, it was a great way to just get out of the bubble
26:29
as well. And yeah, there's nothing like a tour of bus to to be able to do it. So, and yeah, so I still um un I don't
26:35
have the same amount of time I used to now, unfortunately, but I still try and play at least three, four times a year. I have a couple of orchestras I still
26:41
get to perform with. We'll have to get you to do like an intro to the podcast.
26:47
Exactly. Really getting him out of his comfort zone. I have some of my performances on YouTube if you want. So, it's um
26:55
I promise I won't sing. Please don't. I won't. I won't either.
27:00
J karaoke. It's the world. Not a good thing. Yeah. World's best monotone. Um but yeah, just just just opportunity
to be able to do that. You know, it's I wouldn't get I wouldn't get it at the same level that I get back home. So, it's another big reason that I love to
27:13
stay here. Yeah. M now to to steer it back to uh shop talk
27:18

um and and and this is always or for me as a tax account you know um referring
27:24
clients to you is always super easy because um you're responsive you're um
27:30
you're sort of cool calm uh even you've got a very cool head even when things go pear-shaped which is um they sometimes
27:37
do with banks as as we're all aware and um uh and uh so it's always an easy easy
27:44
refer referral for me to send clients down your way. But when's the best time for a client to um come and chat to you
27:50
if they're thinking of buying a house? So yeah, I think um look, there's it's
27:57
probably the most key part of the process, but there's different kind of stages to it because, you know, it
28:03
really helps set the budget, right? And so for a lot of people, they're like, I want to do this, but can I can I
28:08
actually do it? Is the bank going to give me the money to do it? So, um, look, I don't get too precious on it
28:15
being too early. Um, you know, I appreciate it if it's earlier than late. Obviously, I don't like it when people have bought the house and call me and go
28:21
settling in sol. Um,
28:27
but you know there there's clients that I work with for honestly one or two years sometimes and I you know as a
28:32
business we've we still don't charge fees because um I've always found we look after um we look after our clients
28:40
and even if it takes them a while to to do it if we've done multiple pre-approvals and you know they still
28:46
haven't found something. I might be I might be guilty that I'll blame it on my lovely wife which
28:51
keeps changing jobs. you know, like it's, you know, as as a business, it does cost us money each time, but I find
28:57
from a service perspective and from a relationship perspective, we build
29:02

really good relationships with our clients over that period. And I would rather we
29:08
look after you, we get the right outcome for you, and hopefully that means you want to stay with us as well. And
29:13
obviously refer your friends to us. Build that goodwill, builds that trust, build that loyalty, and that's what gives you that long-term relationship.
29:18
Yeah, for sure. So, I've always just, you know, I run I tell my team very simply like our whole job is to make the
29:25
process as easy as possible for our clients and we need to anticipate as much as we can ahead of the process for
29:31
them. So, yeah, people don't get caught out cuz the number one thing that gets the most stressful for most clients is um yeah,
29:38
when you get to the pointy end and things are not as organized as they should be, which um yeah, we all know
29:43
you've probably had those calls as well. But yeah, the short answer is if you want to find out how much you can
29:49
borrow, we're always just happy to talk and we can at least do rough numbers and work out what things look like to start off with. You don't have to go through a
29:54
full application to to work that out. And a a common question a lot of clients ask me and I give them a bit of a
30:01
standard answer, but fixed or variable, it really depends on the time. Um there
30:07
there's a couple of factors. So um you know, and if how do I put it? So
30:13
there there's the main reason that I always think about um fixing a loan rate is obviously rate, right? But the
30:19
biggest reason you should want to fix is to be able to have rate certainty. If you want to know that your cash flow is
30:26
going to be consistent and the same for a period of time and you don't want to stress about things going up or down,
30:33
that's the whole purpose of having a fixed rate. So cuz the reality is it's a gamble. You know, you're kind of taking

30:39
a punt on where you want things to go. Sometimes you're going to win, sometimes you're going to lose. Uh the only time
30:45
that we were for sure going to win is during co when all the rates were two 2 and a half%. You could never lose out when you fixed
30:52
over that period. Any other time even at the moment, right? So they're you know average investment rate at the
30:58
point of filming this it might be before the late hopefully the next rate cut in the next couple of weeks. Um you know the average investment rate for
31:04
now is like around 6.1 6.2. There are investment rates that are five and a half maybe 5.6%.
31:11
So yeah, you could from today bank a 0.5% saving if you fix the rate.
31:16
But it depends on how long you're going to fix for and then you're kind of trying to forecast where things are
31:21
going to be in the next one to two years. We can get a feel for it. Obviously, you know, I love economics. I
31:27
like to try and read the tea leaves as much as as much as anyone, but I always think you've got to go into eyes open
31:32
and know you might you know, there's there's very few cases where you know 100% you're going to win on on where rates are going
31:38
to go. Yeah. Well, there's teams of analysts that sit within banks that make these calls. So,
31:44
that's the that's the hard thing. Like, not saying that you wouldn't be making it, but I know that mom and dads out there can sometimes say, "Well, I'm
31:51
going to fix this rate because it's half percent less." And then, look, and a very very common strategy for us is if if someone wants to have
31:57
some rate certainty or they want to, we can also do split loans. So, you can do some on fixed, some variable as well.
32:02
There's other considerations around fixed or variable. The other, you know, big reason that people keep their loans on variable and this is the biggest
32:08

reason for a lot of our clients is just repayment flexibility. You can take a variable rate loan out and pay it out the next day if you want and there's no
32:15
repayment there's no repayment penalties for doing that. So for a lot of our clients that are up here and get good
32:21
bonuses at a certain point in the year or just really want to maximize offset facilities then most of the time
32:27
especially at the moment people like to just have the flexibility of having variable there. Now, a um I guess
32:34
getting back to the grassroots of our uh this this awesome podcast um is is sort
32:41
of talking about experiences. Um, what's the Has there been any sort of
32:47
client experiences? And sorry, this is a question without notice, Tim, but uh any any client experiences you've had, good,
32:53
bad, or ugly, or indifferent, that you've you've learned from or any any kind of general flavor of
32:58
like if if you had a message to Tim 7 and a half years ago was just opening up Aussie Expat home loans versus TIN now,
33:06
like what would what would the TIN now say that it's in back then about looking after clients or learnings or um or even
33:12
just any specific story? So, pretty general there. Yeah, Jamie. Three in one knows that that question.
33:20
I guess there's kind of two parts to it, right? There's the there's me the mortgage broker and then there's me the business owner. So, and they're
33:26
obviously very connected, but um it's changed a lot from me from being me in my room or me with one or two staff to
33:32
me having a team of people I need to lead now as well. um the first you know the first 3 4 years um I I you know I'm
I'm a very stable and I'm you know very I try and be a very rational person but I also take uh everything with my
33:48
clients very personally too so especially in those early days every single deal I was doing was like very
33:54

personal to me um the process back then was a lot more arduous too because it
34:00
was a lot more manual the guidelines that the banks would issue would kind of move around quite a
34:06
bit. I was, you know, especially the first year just really trying to find my feet as well and work out where I was. So, yeah, I used to have a lot of uh
34:14
sleepless nights or a lot of 3:00 a.m. uh mid, you know, midm morning wakeups and be like, "Oh my god, am I going to
34:20
get this approved today or if it's not approved? What am I going to do for this client?" Like I used to used to carry a lot of stress in the
34:26
first kind of 3, four years. Um you know, thankfully um you know and again because so much of it
34:32
relied on me back then too. you feel a lot of weight on your shoulders, especially when you're taking people through that process. Um, the fortunate
34:40
thing I have now is that I have such an amazing team around me that I don't we
34:46
know what we're doing now. We have such, you know, I've got such good talent or even my all my support team if they, you
34:52
know, especially my even my loan writers, right? They can someone will give us everything and they'll pick out if there's going to be a problem or
34:57
okay, we want to do this but it's going to be an issue later on. So, you know, I the the best thing I've learned is to
35:03
invest in the people around you and really invest in your team because yeah, I'm very lucky. I don't stay up uh
35:10
stressing about deals anymore because we I haven't had anything blow up in the
35:15
same way that it used to back in the early days. But we also It's also the learnings as well because like borrowing money for anyone who has as an
35:22
expat is challenging. It even borrow borrowing money in Australia can be challenging. There's like, okay, well, they put your your tax
35:29
on it over overseas. There's some companies that put FX rates on it. They charge you Australian taxes. So, there's

35:35
all of these different learnings that you've learned over the last 10 years as as as an expat trying to get someone a
35:43
loan. um that there's obvious I know from experiences that the banks keep
35:48
changing um their lending requirements and I think that's part of the the main benefit of using your services is you
35:54
know who to speak to depending on what it is if you're an employee you've got a a salary that come through you've got
36:00
clients who have got their just started their own business which is very difficult to do but you you know how to work with with these kind of clients and
36:06
I think your knowledge base on on back of your experience is what enables you to sleep and and and it's one things and
36:14
my clients have benefited from from those relationships as well. So we also like it, you know, our industry,
36:20
what I could do 12 months ago, what I could do 24 months ago, it's very different. Our lender options, banks
36:25
come in, banks come out, they tinker around with different things. They've got different appetites. Um, right now
36:30
we're in a touch with a really good period where we've got some really good lender partners that are just very consistent. And we also again the the
best thing is my team have just gotten much better at um yeah anticipating and making things easier for people. Yeah
36:44
too. So I appreciate that as well. Being on the front foot you have to do that. Yes 100%.
36:49
Yeah. Very true. And in in terms of you personally like
36:56
traveling Asia um experiencing Asia I know I know you like Europe. Um what is
37:03
it about being being here? Um obviously you've got the the travel you said was
37:08
probably the number one thing. Um how often do you get to switch off? Running a business is very difficult. Um from
37:14

that side I don't think as a business owner you do get to switch off. Um having having a phone is a is a blessing
37:19
and a curse, right? You can you can answer your emails or answer your phone anywhere. WhatsApp's a great a great
37:25
example of that. Yes. Um, but is it is when you do switch off, where do you want to go or or what what
37:30
do you do? Uh, yeah, you never really it never really leaves you. So,
37:36
when you're trying to have a break, it's probably Tristan's fault. Sorry. You can't help yourself. You can't help. But, you know, that the difference is
37:41
now um you know, when I was working at the bank, it it I won't lie, it did feel like a chore most of the time. Even now,
37:47
I always say the worst day I have doing this job is still better than the best day I ever had at the bank because yes,
37:52
it's really tough sometimes. S. Yes, you go through really like difficult challenges. So many different things get thrown you, especially on the business
37:59
side, but it's all worth it at the end of the day because if you put the hard work in, it will come back to you in
spades and you have a lot more control on on your kind of outcome in your future as well. So
38:11
yeah, but if I um yeah, I think the what was the question? What do I
38:17
do you switch off? Which is a no. And where where do you go if you do switch off? Yeah. Yeah. Um I don't I don't so I
38:24
don't care. It's uh look it's a blessing and a curse when the business is growing. It's um I
38:30
mean we're actually at a very interesting point because it was I switched off less when I had three staff
38:36
compared to now when we almost have like almost 20 now. But it's once people get a lot more self-sufficient and can run themselves a
38:43
bit more and I don't need to be in there. That's best thing I've learned as a business owner is to let go of things cuz empower empower the employee is good.
38:50

Yes. And it's, you know, it's the hardest thing to learn because especially if you did it all yourself, you want to you want to have your hand
38:55
in every everything to make sure it's still the way that you do it. But you've got to, especially my staff that have been with
39:00
me for long enough, I trust them. So, they're going to they know what I need. So, it's because you care about client outcomes and you want to make sure that
39:06
whether it's you or someone else within your team, the client gets the same experience and the same bit of care.
39:12
Yeah, for sure. Yeah. Being a being a leader and and leading a team was not something that was very natural to me.
39:17
It's been the I wouldn't say it's the hardest skill. It's probably just the most it was the most unnatural skill for
39:24
me to learn cuz I was so used to just managing myself, controlling my own
39:30
processes and yeah, just being like, why do I have to do all this stuff to can't you just do
39:35
your job kind of thing. Well, it is anything is difficult and like people struggle with it. I've had
39:41
good leaders and um who who I've looked up to and I've had mediocre leaders who I've looked up to as well. So,
39:47
but I think I always just, you know, I I don't want to run my business like a corporate because, you know, I worked at a big bank, right? You guys worked at,
39:53
you know, big banks, you are just a number on a page and no one really cares for you. But actually, every single person that works for me, I value and I
39:59
want them to feel valued as well. So I've just had to learn to
40:04
give them I I they start with a position of trust and you know until they until they break it which thankfully no one
40:11
has so far. Um we keep it that way and they all know what needs to be done. So
40:16
it's a better work environment for everyone then as well. No one wants a micromanager. Yes. No no no. And um
40:23
um so final question I think I'll put it